

The present simple tense

The present simple tense is used to express a constant or repeated action that is happening right now. It can also represent a widespread truth: For example, “I smile all the time.” Regular verbs in the present tense use the infinitive, except for the third person singular, which uses the infinitive plus the ending -s.

I smile We smile
You smile You smile
She smiles They smile

↖ The third person singular is formed by adding an s.

↖ The first, second, and third person take the same form of the verb in the past tense—for both singular and plural.

I laughed We laughed
You laughed You laughed
She laughed They laughed

The past simple tense

The past simple tense expresses an action that began and ended in the past. Regular past tense verbs are formed using the infinitive, followed by the ending -ed.

The future simple tense

The future simple tense is used to express actions that will occur in the future. Regular verbs in the future tense are formed using the auxiliary verb *will*, followed by the infinitive.

I will cry We will cry
You will cry You will cry
She will cry They will cry

↖ The auxiliary verb *will* is used to create the future simple tense.



- Another way of forming the **future simple tense** is to place *am*, *is*, or *are* before *going to*, followed by the infinitive. This form is useful when the action being described is definitely going to happen. For example, “It is going to explode.”
- The three basic tenses are the present, the past, and the future. Each of these tenses has a **simple** form, a **continuous** form, a **perfect** form, and a **perfect continuous** form.

GLOSSARY

Auxiliary verb A “helping” verb like *be* or *have* that joins the main verb in a sentence to the subject.

Infinitive The simplest form of a verb: the form that is used in dictionaries.